

Why feathers?

Feathers protect birds from water and from temperature changes, and they may have evolved on some dinosaurs for the same purpose.

Caudipteryx was a Cretaceous creature.



Feathers provide good insulation from cold.

Caudipteryx had clawed hands. It also had teeth.



Hoatzin are found in parts of South America.

We have claws

Some modern birds have clawed wings. Hoatzin chicks have two tiny claws at the end of each wing. These are not used in the adult, but the chicks use them to clamber through trees.

Did you know?

Although some dinosaurs had feathers, experts are still discussing the possible link between dinosaurs and birds. It does seem unlikely, though, that any dinosaur flew.

Caudipteryx was about the size of a turkey.

Pieces of a puzzle

More and more “dino-birds” are being discovered, and each discovery helps our understanding. This model is based on feathered fossils found in China.

Sinosauropteryx

It was small: about the size of a pigeon.